

Monday, 22 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

28° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

31° 18°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

30° 19°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

19° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 Nine people are in a critical condition after a fatal train crash in Bedford, which also left 100 people injured.

British Transport Police are investigating the collision, which tragically killed a train driver on Friday. It's a truly awful situation.

ACCIDENT · UK

2 A man has been charged following suspected anti-Muslim attacks in Edinburgh over the weekend.

Two people were injured near a mosque, and a man was later seen battering a pizzeria door. CCTV footage showed a topless man driving erratically before abandoning his car and attacking people.

CRIME · UK

3 Two boys and a man have been charged with murder and are due to appear in court today in Newcastle.

They remain in custody ahead of their appearance at Newcastle Magistrates' Court. Details surrounding the incident itself are still emerging.

CRIME · UK

4 A murder investigation is underway in Crystal Palace after a man was stabbed to death.

Police have arrested a man on suspicion of murder following the incident in south-east London. Our thoughts are with everyone affected.

CRIME · UK

5 King Charles is set to reveal his personal tax bill for the very first time as monarch.

This is a significant moment, as the annual financial report for the royals will now include how much tax the King personally pays. It's a move towards greater transparency.

ROYAL · UK

What's coming up

1 **Huge congratulations to Holly Ramsay and Olympic swimmer Adam Peaty who have announced they are expecting their first child!**

The exciting news comes just six months after Gordon Ramsay's daughter and the Olympic champion tied the knot in a star-studded ceremony at Bath Abbey. What a wonderful start to their married life!

ON AIR – What's the most exciting baby news you've heard recently from a celebrity couple?

CELEBRITY · NOW

2 **Kim Kardashian's hair stylist, Chris Appleton, has joined the star-studded line-up for this year's Strictly Come Dancing!**

The British stylist is renowned for working with some of the biggest names in showbiz, including Jennifer Lopez, Katy Perry, and Ariana Grande. He's certainly got a flair for the dramatic, so expect some dazzling routines!

ON AIR – Who would you love to see join the Strictly line-up this year?

TV · AUTUMN

3 **Japanese pop group XG have gone from brutal five-year training to global pop stars, after being recruited before they were even teenagers.**

Their journey highlights the intense dedication and hard work that goes into becoming a global music sensation. They're certainly making waves in the industry!

ON AIR – Would you have what it takes to train for five years to achieve your dreams?

MUSIC · NOW

4 **Michael Fassbender says it's becoming harder and harder to know what to trust online these days.**

The star of the spy thriller 'The Agency' was discussing espionage, AI, and the personal cost of living a double life. It's a topic many of us can relate to in this digital age.

ON AIR – Do you find it difficult to distinguish fact from fiction online?

CELEBRITY · NOW

5 **Are artists like Olivia Rodrigo and Olivia Dean changing pop music with their 'real, raw, and unfiltered' authenticity?**

This relatable style is certainly helping female singers rule the charts. It seems listeners are craving honesty and genuine connection in their music.

ON AIR – Do you prefer artists who are more 'real and raw'?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1

Amber Anning has taken the women's 400m title at the UK Athletics Championships with a new record time!

It was an emotional moment as Keely Hodgkinson withdrew from the final just moments before the race. Anning's impressive time of 50.16 seconds is a new championship record.

ON AIR – What an incredible performance! Who are you tipping for success at the next big athletics event?

ATHLETICS · UK

2

Jake Wightman has claimed the men's 800m title at the UK Athletics Championships in Birmingham.

He finished with a time of 1:45.40 at the Alexander Stadium. It's another fantastic result at the championships.

ON AIR – Do you think we're seeing a new generation of British athletics stars emerge?

ATHLETICS · UK

3

Georgia Hunter Bell has won the women's 800m title with a new championship record time at the UK Athletics Championships.

Her 'dominant display' saw her finish in an incredible 1:55.93. The championships are certainly delivering some thrilling performances!

ON AIR – Which British athlete are you most excited to watch this year?

ATHLETICS · UK

4

Leeds Rhinos have climbed to second in the Women's Super League standings after beating St Helens.

They secured a 28-12 away victory, making a strong statement in the league. It's all to play for as the season progresses!

ON AIR – Are you following the Women's Super League this season? Who do you think will win?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

5

Fifteen-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi has made history by hitting a record 11-ball fifty!

He broke the record for the fastest 50-over List A half-century, incredibly on the same day he wasn't included in India's one-day international squad. What a way to make a point!

ON AIR – What's the most incredible sporting record you've ever witnessed?

CRICKET · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing the joy of 'slow gardening', taking their time to connect with nature.**
Instead of quick fixes, enthusiasts are finding peace in patiently nurturing plants, observing growth, and enjoying the process rather than just the outcome.
- 2 Research suggests that wearing bright colours can genuinely boost your mood and energy levels.**
Psychologists note that vibrant hues can have a positive effect on our minds, making us feel more optimistic and alert throughout the day.
- 3 The art of 'upcycling' old household items into new, stylish decor is experiencing a resurgence.**
People are getting creative, transforming everything from old furniture to forgotten trinkets into unique pieces, giving them a new lease of life and adding character to their homes.
- 4 Experts are highlighting the benefits of 'digital detoxes' – short breaks from screens – for improved well-being.**
Stepping away from phones and computers, even for a few hours, can reduce stress, improve sleep, and help us reconnect with our surroundings.
- 5 A recent study found that listening to 'comforting voices', like those of a favourite radio presenter, can reduce feelings of loneliness.**
The familiar sound creates a sense of companionship and routine, providing a gentle boost to our daily mood.
- 6 The humble 'packed lunch' is getting a gourmet makeover, with many finding joy in preparing thoughtful meals for themselves.**
It's not just about saving money; it's about culinary creativity and enjoying a healthy, personalised meal away from home.
- 7 There's a growing appreciation for 'local history walks', as people discover fascinating stories right on their doorstep.**
Organised tours and self-guided routes are helping communities unearth hidden gems and forgotten tales about their own neighbourhoods.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our shoes as soon as we get through the front door?

ANSWER: TAKING THEM OFF WITH OUR FEET, WITHOUT USING OUR HANDS!

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday 'gesture' instantly makes them feel warm and fuzzy inside. What came out on top?

ANSWER: SOMEONE MAKING YOU A CUP OF TEA WITHOUT EVEN HAVING TO ASK!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those little 'household quirks' that only make sense in our own homes.**
What's a strange or unusual habit, rule, or way of doing things that's unique to your household, that might baffle visitors?
- **You know how sometimes you stumble upon a new 'hobby' or 'interest' that you never expected to enjoy?**
What's something you've recently started doing, or picked up again, that has genuinely surprised you with how much fun it is?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that honey never spoils because bees add a special preservative to it during production?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.48 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.48 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 to 45 minutes.
- A 'bibliosmia' is the enjoyable act of smelling old books.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named Methuselah, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- The 'king' of every deck of cards is the only one without a moustache.
- The human body contains enough iron to make a nail three inches long.
- The phrase 'mind your Ps and Qs' originated from bartenders telling customers to mind their 'pints' and 'quarts'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as 3D wallpaper.

On this day

Day 173 of the year, 192 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron of Aleth; Christian feast day: Alban, first recorded Martyr in Britain (commemoration, Anglicanism); Christian feast day: Blessed Pope Innocent V; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Samosata (Catholic and Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Meryl Streep, American actress
- 1992 — Harry Reid, British actor
- 1962 — Bobby Gillespie, Scottish musician and singer-songwriter
- 1954 — Freddie Prinze, American comedian and actor (died 1977)
- 1964 — Amy Brenneman, American actress
- 1949 — Lindsay Wagner, American actress
- 1944 — Peter Asher, English singer, guitarist, and producer
- 1974 — Donald Faison, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1979 — Former Liberal Party leader Jeremy Thorpe was acquitted of conspiracy to murder Norman Scott, who had accused Thorpe of having a relationship with him.
- 1944 — U.S. President Franklin D. Roosevelt signs into law the Servicemen's Readjustment Act of 1944, commonly known as the G.I. Bill.
- 1966 — Vietnamese Buddhist activist leader Thích Trí Quang was arrested as the military junta of Nguyen Cao Ky crushed the Buddhist Uprising.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2025 — The United States conducts airstrikes on three Iranian nuclear sites in Fordow, Natanz, and Isfahan.
- 1969 — The Cuyahoga River catches fire in Cleveland, Ohio, drawing national attention to water pollution, and spurring the passing of the Clean Water Act and the creation of the Environmental Protection Agency.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1979 — Former Liberal Party leader Jeremy Thorpe was acquitted of conspiracy to murder Norman Scott, who had accused Thorpe of having a relationship with him.

- 1965 — The Treaty on Basic Relations between Japan and the Republic of Korea is signed.
- 2022 — An earthquake occurs in eastern Afghanistan resulting in over 1,000 deaths.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 174 of the year, 191 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æthelthryth; Christian feast day: Joseph Cafasso; Christian feast day: Blessed Maria Raffaella Cimatti; Christian feast day: Marie of Oignies. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Adam Faith, English singer (died 2003)
- 1975 — David Howell, English golfer
- 1962 — Chuck Billy, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1969 — Martin Klebba, American actor, producer, and stuntman
- 1940 — Stuart Sutcliffe, Scottish painter and musician (died 1962)
- 1986 — Christy Altomare, American actress and singer-songwriter
- 1929 — June Carter Cash, American singer-songwriter, musician, and actress (died 2003)
- 1972 — Selma Blair, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2001 — The 8.4 Mw southern Peru earthquake shakes coastal Peru with a maximum Mercalli intensity of VIII (Severe). A destructive tsunami followed, leaving at least 74 people dead, and 2,687 injured.
- 2013 — Nik Wallenda becomes the first man to successfully walk across the Grand Canyon on a tight rope.
- 2018 — Twelve boys and an assistant coach from a soccer team in Thailand are trapped in a flooding cave, leading to an 18-day rescue operation.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1961 — The Antarctic Treaty System, which sets aside Antarctica as a scientific preserve and limits military activity on the continent, its islands and ice shelves, comes into force.
- 1951 — The ocean liner SS United States is christened and launched.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)